Conflict and Peace

Week 11: Consequences of migration and host society perception

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What we know about migration so far

Share of migrants increasing across many countries

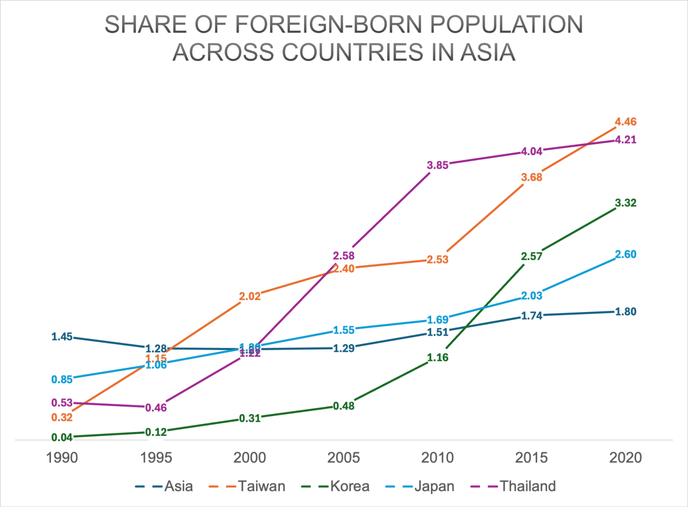
- 2024: 304 million people globally are migrants, roughly 4% (UNDESA)
- Global South to North migration: Seeking labor and educational opportunities
- Rising share of migration across countries within Global South
- Internally displaced persons on the rise: 83 million people (UNDESA)
    - Those forced to flee violence, disasters, or crises but remain within country borders

Reasons for migration are also diverse

- Primary motivation are for labor and educational opportunities
- But there are also political migrants: Those fleeing conflicts and political instability
- Increasing share of those fleeing environmental disasters

With rising conflicts and natural disasters globally, understanding forced migration is crucial

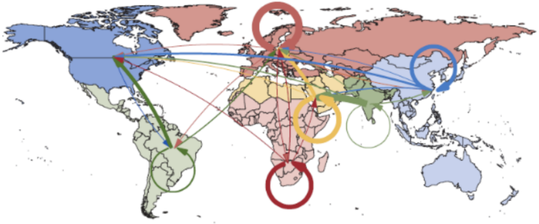
Growth in migrant populations, even in Asia



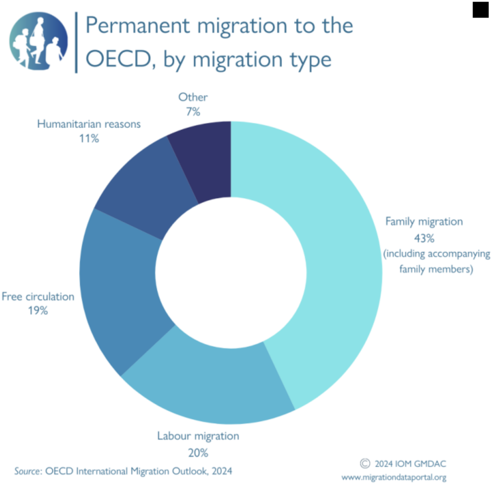
Source: UN Department of Economics and Social Affairs (Note: For US, 9.2% → 15.2%; Europe: 7.1% → 12.6%)

Migration dynamics and rationale

Migration flows
Migration takes place within broadly defined world regions, such as within Europe and Central Asia, but also over long distances.



Sources: United Nations and IMF staff calculations.
Note: The figure shows migration flows larger than 200,000 people between 2010 and 2020. The width of flows is proportional to the number of migrants.



How do migrants integrate into host societies?

This is a two-way effort: Effort of migrants and the natives

- So far, emphasis on the Effects of migrants on host society
  - Impact of migrant workers on themselves and natives (Peri et al 2016 and many more)
  - Impact of migrant voters on electoral outcomes (Barbsai et al 2017; Mayda et al 2022)
  - Migrant & Second generation (Bleakly, Chin 2010; Bratsberg et al 2020)
- We know relatively little about how natives in the host societies affect integration
  - Are they perceived with prejudice as outsiders? How?
  - Are these based on accurate or misguided information?
  - What does it imply for migrant integration and policies?

In this lecture, we focus the impacts of forced migration (political and climate migrants)

In addition, we look at how migrant perceptions of natives affect integration and policies

Roadmap for today

1. Overview of the topic

2. Consequences of migration
   2.1 Card (1990): The Impact of Mariel Boatlift on the Miami Labor Market
   2.2 Waldinger (2010): Quality Matters: The Expulsion of Professors and Consequences for PhD Student Outcomes in Nazi Germany
   2.3 Mahajan, Yang (2020): Taken by Storm: Hurricanes, Migrant Networks, and US Immigration
   2.4 Becker, Grosfeld, Grosjean, Voigländer, and Zhuravskaya (2020): Forced Migration and Human Capital: Evidence from Post WWII Population Transfers [Student presentation]

3. How do natives (hosts) perceive migrants
   3.1 Fouka, Tabellini (2022): Changing In-Group Boundaries: The Effect of Immigration on Race Relations in the United States
   3.2 Alesina, Miano, Stantcheva (2023): Immigration and Redistribution
   3.3 Hainmueller, Hiscox (2010): Attitudes toward Highly-Skilled and Low-Skilled Immigration: Evidence from a Survey Experiment [student presentation]

Card (1990):
The Impact of Mariel Boatlift on the Miami Labor Market

Q: How does migrant inflow affect labor market?

Migration policy debates center around how migrants affect native workers' outcomes

- How does it affect their wages and employment?
- If migrants substitute native workers, lower wages and employment for natives
- If migrants complement native workers, effects may not be straightforward
  - Migrants and natives may have different skill sets: May not compete for same jobs
  - Some natives (e.g. high-skilled) are probably not as affected as others (e.g. low-skilled)
  - Host society can absorb these changes (Demand for specific workers $\Uparrow$)
- Still debating on how this affects native worker outcomes in various settings

We look at one of the earliest works that started this debate

- Leverages sudden and large inflow of Cuban migrants to a concentrated area (Miami)
- Micro-data that identifies migrants & pre-migrant labor market situations

Migrant inflow following Mariel Boatlift (Exodo del Mariel)

What is Mariel Boatlift?

- Approx. 120,000 Cubans entered US in 05/1980 - 09/1980
- After Cuban govt announcement that anyone who wanted to leave Cuba could do so
- Half of them settled in Miami & high % of less-skilled workers with low English fluency
- Lower occupation attainment when compared to earlier cohorts of Cuban migrants

Labor market in Miami around Mariel Boatlift

- Miami: Migrant intensive even before the Boatlift (35.5% of population foreign-born)
- Also had large Black American contingent (17.3% of population)
- Cubans and other Hispanics primarily work as craftsmen and operatives
- Black Americans in Laborer and service-related occupations
- White Americans in in Technical and Manager positions

Data and empirical strategy

Data sources

- 1979-1985 individual data from Current population survey (CPS)
  - Also includes pre-Boatlift Miami labor market outcomes
  - Cubans separately identified in CPS (vs ‘other Hispanics’)
  - Relatively large Miami sample - 1,200 per month

Empirical findings leverage pre vs post Boatlift trends in different cities

- Compare: Atlanta, LA, Houston, Tampa (similar demographics and economic growth)
- Looks at hourly earnings, and unemployment across different demographic groups
- Similar to DiD (but not exact - Miami had lower earnings than others pre-Boatlift)
- Control for education, age, gender, race, gender $\rightarrow$ Generate predicted wage

Wage differences stable over the period for non-Cubans

Table 5. Means of Log Wages of Non-Cubans in Miami by Quartile of Predicted Wages, 1979–85. (Standard Errors in Parentheses)

	Mean of Log Wage by Quartile of Predicted Wage				
Year	*1st Quart.*	*2nd Quart.*	*3rd Quart.*	*4th Quart.*	*Difference of Means: 4th − 1st*
1979	1.31	1.61	1.71	2.15	.84
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(.04)	(.05)
1980	1.31	1.52	1.74	2.09	.77
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(.04)	(.05)
1981	1.40	1.57	1.79	2.06	.66
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(.04)	(.05)
1982	1.24	1.57	1.77	2.04	.80
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(.04)	(.05)
1983	1.27	1.53	1.76	2.11	.84
	(.03)	(.04)	(.03)	(.05)	(.06)
1984	1.33	1.59	1.80	2.12	.79
	(.03)	(.04)	(.04)	(.04)	(.05)
1985	1.27	1.57	1.81	2.14	.87
	(.04)	(.04)	(.04)	(.05)	(.06)

Note: Predicted wage is based on a linear prediction equation for the log wage fitted to individuals in four comparison cities; see text. The sample consists of non-Cubans (male and female, white, black, and Hispanic) between the ages of 16 and 61 with valid wage data in the earnings supplement of the Current Population Survey. Wages are deflated by the Consumer Price Index (1980 = 100).

Stable employment differentials for low-skilled Blacks

Table 6. Comparison of Wages, Unemployment Rates, and Employment Rates for Blacks in Miami and Comparison Cities.
(Standard Errors in Parentheses)

	All Backs				*Low-Education Blacks*			
	Difference in Log Wages, Miami − Comparison		*Difference in Emp./Unemp., Miami − Comparison*		*Difference in Log Wages, Miami − Comparison*		*Difference in Emp./Unemp., Miami − Comparison*	
Year	*Actual*	*Adjusted*	*Emp. − Pop. Rate*	*Unemp. Rate*	*Actual*	*Adjusted*	*Emp. − Pop. Rate*	*Unemp. Rate*
1979	−.15	−.12	.00	−2.0	−.13	−.15	.03	−.8
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(1.9)	(.05)	(.05)	(.04)	(3.8)
1980	−.16	−.12	.05	−7.1	−.07	−.07	.03	−8.2
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(1.6)	(.05)	(.05)	(.04)	(3.5)
1981	−.11	−.10	.02	−3.0	−.05	−.11	.04	−7.7
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(2.0)	(.05)	(.05)	(.04)	(4.2)
1982	−.24	−.20	−.06	3.3	−.17	−.20	−.04	.6
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(2.4)	(.05)	(.05)	(.04)	(4.7)
1983	−.21	−.15	−.02	.1	−.13	−.11	.04	−3.3
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(2.7)	(.06)	(.05)	(.04)	(4.7)
1984	−.10	−.05	−.04	2.1	−.04	−.03	.05	.1
	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(2.4)	(.06)	(.05)	(.04)	(4.7)
1985	−.05	−.01	−.06	−5.5	.18	.09	.00	−4.7
	(.04)	(.04)	(.04)	(2.6)	(.07)	(.07)	(.06)	(5.6)

Notes: Low-education blacks are those with less than 12 years of completed education. Adjusted differences in log wages between blacks in Miami and comparison cities are obtained from a linear regression model that includes education, potential experience, and other control variables; see text. Wages are deflated by the Consumer Price Index (1980 = 100). "Emp.-Pop. Rate" refers to the employment:population ratio. "Unemp. Rate" refers to the unemployment rate among those in the labor force.

- Differences likely due to 1982 recession (not Boatlift)

Labor market outcomes for Cuban population stable across the period

Table 7. Means of Log Wages of Cubans in Miami: Actual and Predicted, and by Quartile of Predicted Wages. (Standard Errors in Parentheses)

	Mean of Log Wages Log in Miami			*Mean of Log Wages by Quartile of Predicted Wages*					*Difference in Cuban Wages, Miami − Rest-of-U.S.*	
Year	*Actual*	*Pre-dicted*	*Actual-Pre-dicted*	*1st*	*2nd*	*3rd*	*4th*	*Mean Log Wage of Cubans Outside Miami*	*Actual*	*Ad-justed*
1979	1.58	1.73	−.15	1.31	1.44	1.64	1.90	1.71	−.13	−.10
	(.02)	(.02)	(.03)	(.02)	(.03)	(.04)	(.05)	(.04)	(.04)	(.04)
1980	1.54	1.68	−.14	1.25	1.49	1.59	1.81	1.66	−.12	−.06
	(.02)	(.02)	(.03)	(.02)	(.05)	(.04)	(.05)	(.03)	(.04)	(.03)
1981	1.51	1.68	−.17	1.23	1.43	1.55	1.80	1.63	−.13	−.09
	(.02)	(.02)	(.03)	(.03)	(.03)	(.04)	(.05)	(.03)	(.04)	(.03)
1982	1.49	1.68	−.19	1.27	1.43	1.50	1.77	1.71	−.22	−.12
	(.02)	(.02)	(.03)	(.03)	(.04)	(.04)	(.06)	(.03)	(.04)	(.03)
1983	1.48	1.65	−.17	1.16	1.41	1.56	1.80	1.62	−.14	−.08
	(.03)	(.02)	(.03)	(.02)	(.04)	(.04)	(.06)	(.03)	(.04)	(.03)
1984	1.53	1.69	−.17	1.20	1.40	1.65	1.88	1.63	−.10	−.08
	(.03)	(.02)	(.03)	(.03)	(.04)	(.05)	(.06)	(.03)	(.04)	(.03)
1985	1.49	1.67	−.18	1.19	1.43	1.53	1.80	1.77	−.27	−.19
	(.04)	(.03)	(.05)	(.06)	(.06)	(.08)	(.09)	(.06)	(.07)	(.05)

Notes: Predicted wage is based on a linear prediction equation for the log wage fitted to individuals in four comparison cities; see text. Predicted wages for Cubans in Miami are based on coefficients for Hispanics in comparison cities. The adjusted wage gap between Cubans in Miami and Cubans in the rest of the U.S. are obtained from a linear regression model that includes education, potential experience, and other control variables; see text. Wages are deflated by the Consumer Price Index (1980 = 100).

Subsequent studies and remaining questions

What did the subsequent studies find?

- Card (1990): No effect on non-Cuban and Cubans (Absorbed additional labor force)
- Borjas (many, including 2017): Large wage $\Downarrow$ for high school dropouts
- Peri & Yasenov (2019): Using synthetic controls, finds limited effect on that high-school dropout wages
- Clemens & Hunt (2019): Wage decline explained by race composition changes uniquely within Miami CPS subsamples. Using stable samples, they find no effect on low-skill wages

Remaining questions

- What happens to home countries of migrants?
  - Home country loses human capital that could have contributed
  - Especially since most migrants are in the productive stages of their lives
- How do migrants determine where to settle?
  - Many migrants can choose where to live, do they follow network of previous migrants?

Waldinger (2010):
Quality Matters: The Expulsion of Professors and Consequences for PhD Student Outcomes in Nazi Germany

Q: How does migration affect innovation at home nation?

Quality of workers determines potential for innovation

- University quality $\rightarrow$ successful professional career, innovation of students
  - For PhD students, this means getting publications, patents, and future jobs
- Many key determinants: Professors, department resources etc
- Causal analysis difficult
  - Selection bias: Top quality students select into top schools
  - Omitted variable bias: quality of laboratories and research programs

This paper leverages dismissal of professors to study how migration affects innovation

- Nazi Germany dismissed 'politically unreliable' professors from German Universities
- Mathematics were particularly hard-hit: Many were Jews or were labeled as such
- Looks at how sudden dismissal affected student outcomes and innovation

Expulsion of professors by Nazi Regime

Who were dismissed by the Nazi government

- ‘Law for the Restoration of the Professional Civil Service’
- Non-Aryans (Jews in particular), Any professors who supported opposition
- Led to dismissals and ‘early retirements’ from German Universities
- Mathematics: About 18% of all professors dismissed in 1933-34
- Many fled to foreign universities (mostly US) and unable to advise former students
- Top departments (Gottingen, Berlin) were hard hit

Who were the PhD students of Math in Germany

- Focus on PhD students who obtained degree by 1938
- Those from top universities are more likely to publish and become full professors
- Some also got high school teacher license

Data and empirical strategy

Data sources

- Students: Career outcomes of ‘23-‘38 cohort from German Mathematical Association
- Professor data: List of Displaced German Scholars, University Calendar
- Department quality: Avg # of citation-weighted publications in top journals

Regression that leverages exogenous changes in department quality due to dismissals

$$Y_{idt} = \beta_1 + \beta_2 \text{Quality}_{dt-1} + \beta_3 \text{S/F Ratio}_{dt-1} + \gamma X_{idt} + \phi_t + \psi_d + e_{idt}$$

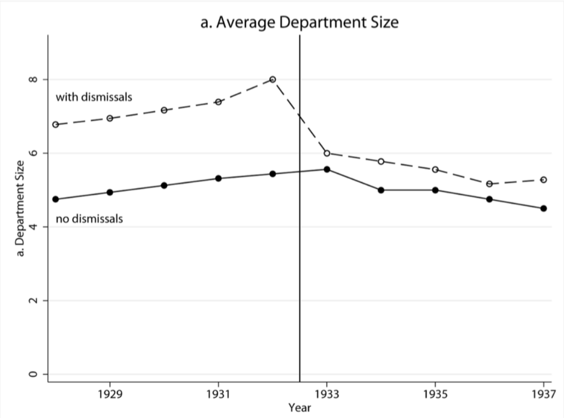
- Two variables likely endogenous: Adjust for changes induced by dismissals
  - Dismissal induced reduction in faculty quality (higher value $\rightarrow$ larger fall)

$$(Avg.1932 \text{ Quality}) - (Avg.1932 \text{ Quality of stayers})$$

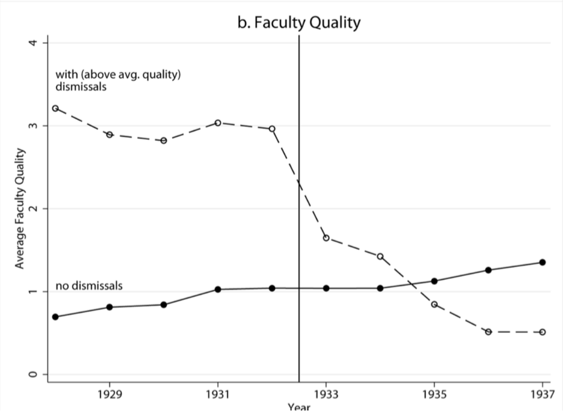
  - Dismissal induced increase in S/F ratio:

$$\frac{\#1932 \text{ student}}{\#1932 \text{ Prof} - \#\text{Dismissed Prof}} - \frac{\#1932 \text{ student}}{\#1932 \text{ Prof}}$$

Significant drop-off in quality of departments with dismissals



(a) Department size



(b) Faculty quality

Drop-off in PhD student outcomes correlated with quality

TABLE 6
INSTRUMENTAL VARIABLES

	Dependent Variable							
	Published Top		Full Professor		Number of Lifetime Citations		Positive Lifetime Citations	
	OLS (1)	IV (2)	OLS (3)	IV (4)	OLS (5)	IV (6)	OLS (7)	IV (8)
Average faculty quality	.056**	$\boxed{.102^{**}}$	.037	$\boxed{.076^{**}}$	2.388*	$\boxed{4.901^{**}}$	.068*	$\boxed{.125^{**}}$
	(.018)	$\boxed{(.015)}$	(.021)	$\boxed{(.015)}$	(1.119)	$\boxed{(1.546)}$	(.026)	$\boxed{(.016)}$
Student/faculty ratio	.000	.003	.000	−.001	.040	−.284	.002	.003
	(.001)	(.002)	(.001)	(.003)	(.106)	(.328)	(.001)	(.004)
Female	−.015	−.022	−.099*	−.103**	−8.711**	−8.850**	−.090	−.099
	(.059)	(.055)	(.041)	(.036)	(2.756)	(2.436)	(.068)	(.062)
Foreigner	.014	.022	−.134*	−.135*	.803	.016	−.025	−.019
	(.048)	(.045)	(.053)	(.053)	(5.136)	(5.262)	(.072)	(.074)
Cohort dummies	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Department fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	690	690	690	690	690	690	690	690
R^2	.163		.155		.080		.126	
Cragg-Donald eigenvalue statistic		25.2		25.2		25.2		25.2

NOTE.—All standard errors are clustered at the department level.
*Significant at the 5 percent level.

Effects driven by changes in top 10 institutions

	Sample			
	Top 10 Department		Lower-Ranked Department	
	OLS	IV	OLS	IV
Dependent Variable	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Published top:				
Average faculty quality	.059**	.094**	.012	−.214
	(.014)	(.022)	(.032)	(.259)
Student/faculty ratio	−.001	.002	.001	.016
	(.002)	(.003)	(.002)	(.026)
Full professor:				
Average faculty quality	.046*	.074**	−.086*	−.065
	(.017)	(.019)	(.034)	(.214)
Student/faculty ratio	−.001	−.001	.001	−.000
	(.002)	(.003)	(.003)	(.023)
Number of lifetime citations:				
Average faculty quality	2.092*	2.667**	−4.570	−6.032
	(.685)	(.557)	(3.396)	(24.717)
Student/faculty ratio	.071	.156	.023	.158
	(.167)	(.211)	(.156)	(2.914)
Positive lifetime citations:				
Average faculty quality	.092**	.138**	−.055	−.164
	(.016)	(.020)	(.043)	(.204)
Student/faculty ratio	−.001	.003	.003	.007
	(.002)	(.003)	(.002)	(.020)
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Cohort dummies	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Department fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	352	352	338	338
Cragg-Donald eigenvalue statistic		30.0		.8

Takeaways and discussions

Departure of talent does affect productivity and outcomes of remaining students

- Quality of faculty has sizeable effects on student outcomes at German Universities
- Quality of instruction matters even in selective settings
- Departure of key talents could have long-run productivity consequence at home

Remaining questions

- Are these effects persistent? Depends on whether the talent returns home
  - Not applicable here: These professors could not return to Germany
  - Return migrants can transfer knowledge and resources from foreign countries
- Other ways in which migrants affect innovation and productivity
  - Studies using how visa restrictions (H1B in US)$\rightarrow \Downarrow$ patents, $\Uparrow$ Outsourcing by US firms
  - Potentially suggest that migrant labor may not be replaced with domestic labor

Mahajan, Yang (2020):
Taken by Storm: Hurricanes, Migrant Networks, and US Immigration

Q: Do negative shocks at origin countries increase migration?

Many unanswered questions in migration, with mixed theoretical and empirical findings

- Negative shocks at home lead to increase or decrease in international migration?
- What roles do network of prior migrants play in outmigration decision?
- Are these driven by legal or illegal channels?
- Are these migrations likely to be temporary or permanent?

This paper uses hurricanes to estimate impact of natural disasters on migration decisions

- 25 years of hurricanes data covering 159 origin countries of US migrants
- Examines how prior migrant presence affects future migrant flows
- Uses these data to answer theoretical ambiguities
  - Individuals decide to stay home vs move to attractive location
  - Rising fixed cost of moving out vs Returns to migration higher
  - Migrant networks may reduce migration costs vs reduce migration needs ($\because$ remittances)

Conceptual justification can go either way

Stay at home location vs move to more attractive location

- If one chooses to move, there is a fixed cost to migrate
- After shock: Destination becomes (relatively) more attractive vs Moving costs rises
  - Increased demand raises cost of migration services
  - Make it difficult to obtain credit to finance migration

Migrant network may also have a complicated role

- Earlier research: Larger network$\rightarrow \Downarrow$ Fixed costs
  - Reduce search and information costs, social support, and sponsor relatives
- Prior migrants as insurance network, reducing need to migrate
  - Can send financial assistance home (remittances) that helps with coping the shock
  - This can happen instead of helping them migrate in response to shocks

$\Rightarrow$Uses empirical analysis to identify which channel is working

Data and empirical strategy

Data sources

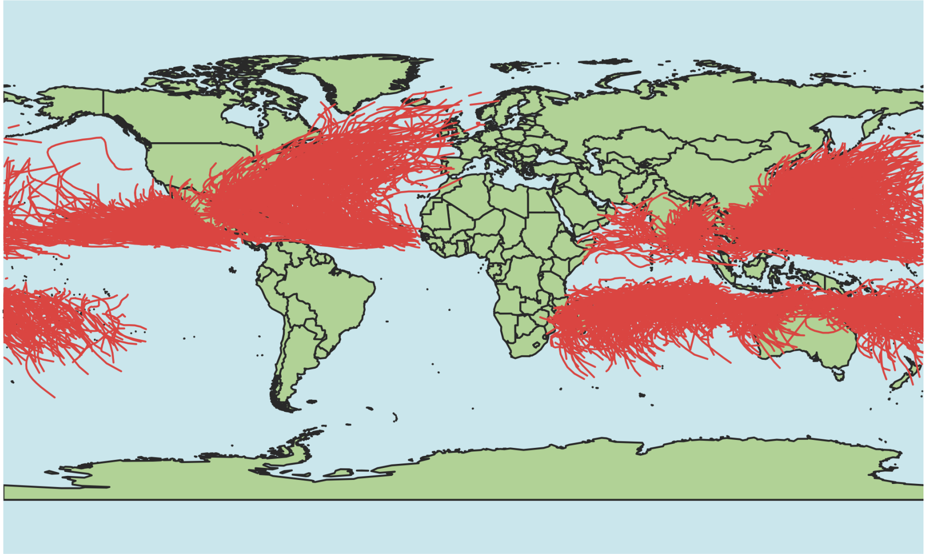
- US immigration rates: 1980-2004 for each observable origins (US Census data)
- Hurricanes: Tracks from National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration
- Migrant networks: Census, American Community Survey, and DHS data

Leverage variation in returns to migration across time and origin locations

$$Y_{jt} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 H_{jt} + \beta_2 (H_{jt} \times s_{j,1980}) + \eta_j + \delta_t + \phi_j \times t + e_{jt}$$

- H_{jt}: Hurricane index for origin j at year t
- $s_{j,1980}$: Stock of migrants from j at US in 1980
- β_1 measures effect of hurricanes on migration
- β_2 captures differentiated effects of hurricanes based on prior migrant network

How does the hurricane track data look like?



Increased migration, amplified by presence of migrant networks

	As a proportion of 1980 population	
	Migrants(t)	Migrants(t)
	(1)	(2)
Hurricane index(t)	0.0040	−0.0010
	(0.0020)	(0.0010)
Hurricane index(t) × 1980 proportional immigrant stock		0.1163
		(0.0451)
Country-years	3,900	3,900
R^2	0.4319	0.4409
Countries	159	159

Notes: Each column refers to an OLS specification with a constant term, country fixed effects, year fixed effects, and country-specific time trends, along with the variables displayed. Standard errors clustered at the country level. See equations (1) and (2). "Migrants" and "1980 proportional immigrant stock" are constructed using restricted-access data from the US Census Bureau's Research Data Center.

Increases are driven by naturalized migrants

Table 5—The Effect of Hurricanes on Migration by Citizenship of Stock, 1980–2004

	As a proportion of 1980 population	
	Migrants(t)	Migrants(t)
Hurricane index(t)	−0.0010	−0.0005
	(0.0010)	(0.0009)
Hurricane index(t) × 1980 proportional immigrant stock	0.1163	
	(0.0451)	
Hurricane index(t) × 1980 proportional immigrant citizen stock		0.4044
		(0.2245)
Hurricane index(t) × 1980 proportional immigrant noncitizen stock		−0.1444
		(0.1661)
Country-years	3,900	3,900
R^2	0.4409	0.4429
Countries	159	159
p-value: equal interaction effect		0.1540

Notes: Each column refers to an OLS specification with a constant term, country fixed effects, year fixed effects, and country-specific time trends, along with the variables displayed. Standard errors clustered at the country level. See equations (2) and (3). "Hurricane index" refers to the hurricane index for a given country in year t. "Migrants," "1980 proportional immigrant stock," "1980 proportional immigrant citizen stock," and "1980 proportional immigrant noncitizen stock" constructed using restricted-access data from the US Census Bureau's Research Data Center.

Additional findings and remaining questions

Additional findings

- Using different sources of migration data (DHS) does not change results
- Effects are driven by youngest (0-12 y.o) and prime age (18-44 y.o) migrants
  - Those who migrate for work related reasons and their children
- Family sponsorships (not refugees or employment sponsor) are key networks
- This is driven by increase in desire to migrate
  - Leniency programs by US (TPS and DED) did not change

Remaining questions

- Implications for climate-driven migration
  - Increasing importance due to increases in natural disasters
- Causation for any studies with immigration treatment: Selection due to prior networks
  - Shift-share IV: Early-stage migrants shares and contemporary shifts

Becker, Grosfeld, Grosjean, Voigländer, and Zhuravskaya (2020): Forced Migration and Human Capital: Evidence from Post WWII Population Transfers [Student presentation]

Fouka, Tabellini (2022):
Changing In-Group Boundaries: The Effect of Immigration on Race Relations in the United States

Q: How are in/out-group boundaries formed in multigroup relations?

Categorization of in/out-group members explain attitudes of the majority group

- In-group favoritism and out-group prejudice $\rightarrow$ Possible conflict & violence
- The boundaries change through interactions $\rightarrow$ Even in multigroup setting?
- Demographic shifts from migration serves as natural experiment
  - Introduction of a new minority group
  - Shift prejudice from one minority to other? Lump all minorities together?

This paper studies how inflow of new migrants affects perception of existing minorities

- Leverage variation in Mexican migrants and perception on Black Americans
- *Affective distance* and size determines which attributes matter for social categorization
  - Individual's feelings towards members of different groups relative to their own
  - Relative size affects intergroup relations

Conceptual Framework: Dynamics of categorizing in and out-groups

Attributes used for classification are determined by group share and affective distance

- Classification maximizes ratio of across-group differences over in-group differences
- For attribute j, let $I_j^k = 1$ if group k differ from in-group in terms of j (0 if same)
- For group k with size n^k with affective distance δ^k, salient attribute j maximizes

$$\max_j R_j = \underbrace{\frac{\sum_k \delta^k n^k I_j^k}{\sum_k n^k I_j^k}}_{\substack{\text{weighted avg of} \\ \delta \text{ across out-groups}}} \Big/ \underbrace{\frac{\sum_k \delta^k n^k (1 - I_j^k)}{\sum_k n^k (1 - I_j^k)}}_{\substack{\text{weighted avg of} \\ \delta \text{ across in-groups}}}$$

Takeaway

- Group composition change (size) $\rightarrow$ Salient attribute changes (immigration over race)
- Existing groups can be recategorized from outsider to insider depending on
  - Whether it differs from rising groups in terms of attributes
  - Affective distance and size of the incoming group

Data and empirical strategy

Data sources

- Migrants: Census (1970-2010), American National Election Study (ANES)
- Sentiment: Feelings thermometer + stereotypical views from ANES

Empirical strategy leverages Mexican and other migrant inflow and attitudes (DID)

$$y_{irst} = \beta_1 M_{rst} + \beta_2 S_{rst} + X_{irst} + \gamma_{rs} + \mu_{rt} + \eta_{irst}$$

- M_{rst}: Share of Mexican migrants in census tract r in state s at time t
- S_{rst}: Share of non-Mexican migrants in census tract r in state s at time t
- M_{rst} and S_{rst} can be endogenous
  - Instrument with predicted share of migrants using 1960 settlement shares (Shift-share IV)
  - Relevance: Idea is that new inflow of migrants tends to follow previous ones
  - Exogeneity: States with high share of Mexicans in '60 not on different y_{irst} trajectory

Favorable towards Blacks, not so for Hispanics

TABLE 1. Effects on Whites' Attitudes toward Blacks

Dependent variable	Feeling thermometer Blacks		Average attitudes	
	OLS	2SLS	OLS	2SLS
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Share Mexican	–14.272	78.940	–1.677	4.294
	(29.189)	(36.965)	(1.289)	(1.773)
R^2	0.034	0.014	0.032	0.010
F-statistic		131.3		132.1
Observations	17,188	17,188	17,446	17,446
Number of states	51	51	51	51
Mean dep. var.	63.31	63.31	–0.129	–0.129

TABLE 2. Effects on Whites' Attitudes toward Hispanics

Dependent variable	Feeling thermometer		Average attitudes	
	OLS	2SLS	OLS	2SLS
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Share Mexican	44.402	–329.182	1.046	–11.050
	(60.479)	(183.880)	(2.933)	(5.994)
R^2	0.061	0.001	0.066	–0.000
F-statistic		90.71		89.42
Observations	11,399	11,399	11,672	11,672
Number of states	51	51	51	51
Mean dep. var.	61.52	61.52	–0.0661	–0.0661

Driven by increased salience of immigration over race

TABLE 3. Most Important Problem in the Country

Dependent variable	Immigration policies		Racial problems (negative)		Racial problems (positive)	
	OLS	2SLS	OLS	2SLS	OLS	2SLS
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Share Mexican	0.290	0.154	–0.096	–0.143	0.406	0.478
	(0.125)	(0.078)	(0.118)	(0.176)	(0.092)	(0.088)
R^2	0.01	0.00	0.02	0.00	0.01	0.00
F-statistic		154.7		154.7		154.7
Observations	10,726	10,726	10,726	10,726	10,726	10,726
Number of states	46	46	46	46	46	46
Mean dep. var.	0.005	0.005	0.001	0.001	0.005	0.005

Composition of hate crime victims change

TABLE 5. Mexican Immigration and Hate Crimes

Dependent variable	Hate crimes per 100,000 people			
	All offenders		White offenders	
	OLS	2SLS	OLS	2SLS
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Panel A: Black victims				
Share Mexican	–0.007	–1.405	0.038	–2.410
	(0.045)	(0.635)	(0.054)	(1.231)
	{0.040}	{0.656}	{0.046}	{1.146}
R^2	0.666	–0.273	0.681	–0.828
F-statistic		10.37		7.574
Observations	4,350	4,350	3,547	3,547
Number of counties	1662	1662	1376	1376
Mean dep. var.	0.0254	0.0254	0.0108	0.0108
Panel B: Hispanic victims				
Share Mexican	0.193	0.395	0.161	1.227
	(0.216)	(0.926)	(0.248)	(1.359)
	{0.200}	{0.883}	{0.246}	{1.443}
R^2	0.582	–0.001	0.619	–0.161
F-statistic		10.37		7.574
Observations	4,350	4,350	3,547	3,547
Number of counties	1662	1662	1376	1376
Mean dep. var.	0.00365	0.00365	–0.0124	–0.0124

Note: Beta coefficients reported. Standard errors clustered at the county level are reported in parentheses; Conley standard errors using a distance cutoff of 500 km are reported in curly brackets.

Takeaways and discussions

Inflow of migration changes boundaries of who is in or out

- Distant group size (Mexicans) $\Uparrow \rightarrow$ favorable attitudes towards existing minorities
- Shifting salient issue (migration) determines recategorization of in/out-groups
- Results generalized to wider set of ethnicities (Asians in-group, Muslims out-group)

Remaining questions

- Is size the most pressing factor in determining affective distance?
  - Southeast Asian worker migrants still viewed out-group, despite size
  - Other factors contribute to affective distance? (e.g. economic/educational background?)
- Are all ingroup members the same?
  - Black Americans still not considered equal to White Americans
  - Differences within Hispanics (Cuban and Venezuelans vs other Hispanics)
  - In-groups can be broken up? (e.g. media / socioeconomics / gentrification)

Alesina, Miano, Stantcheva (2023): Immigration and Redistribution

Q: Does immigration change policy support?

Conflicts on policy designs, particularly redistribution, following increase in immigration

- Do citizens have accurate perception about migrants?
  - Do they over/underestimate the share of migrant population?
  - Do they believe that immigrants burden welfare system without contributing to it?
  - Do they believe that immigrants are culturally distant?
- What is the link between the perceptions and support for redistribution policy?
  - Do treatments that aim to correct perceptions affect opinions on these policies?

This paper uses survey experiment to address how immigration affects policy preferences

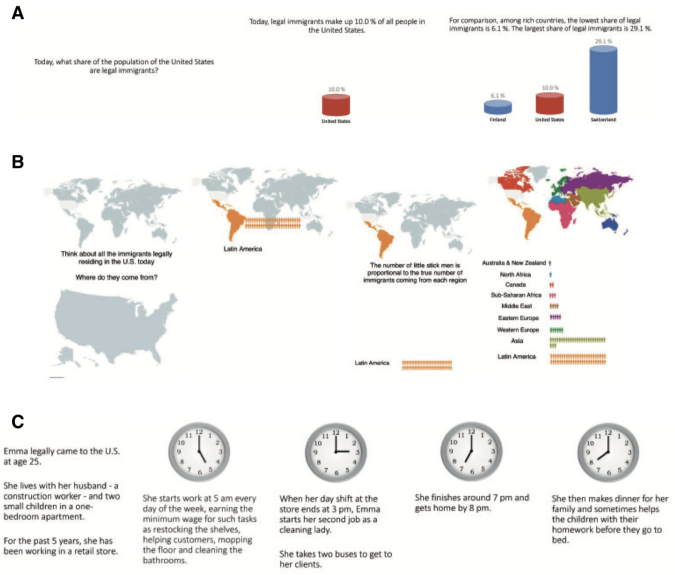
- Online survey on 22,000 people across 6 countries (US, UK, FRA, GER, ITA, SWE)
- Gather information on perception on migrants and preferences for redistribution
- Various treatment to test if highlighting migration affects policy opinions

Data and empirical strategy

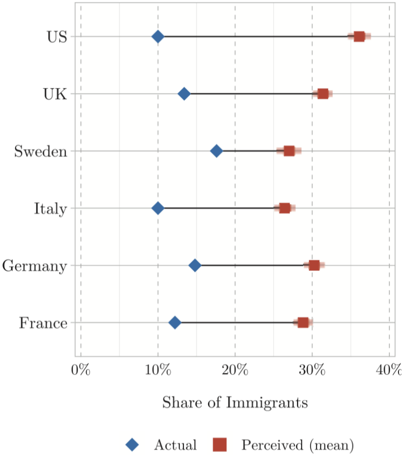
Randomized survey experiment design: salience treatment and information treatment

- Background info: Gender, age, education, employment, political orientation etc
- Salience treatment: Immigration block before redistribution block (control: vice versa)
  - *Tests whether making migration salient affects policy preferences*
  - Immigration: Ask perception on immigrants, views on immigration policy
  - Redistribution: Ask redistribution and govt role questions (no reference to migrants)
- Information treatment: Control group and three types of information
  - *Tests whether providing additional information changes the effect of salience*
  - Video 1 on the share of immigrants
  - Video 2 on the origins of the immigrants
  - Video 3 that emphasizes hard work of immigrants (no facts)
- 8 groups of treatment arms: Uses OLS to compare across the groups

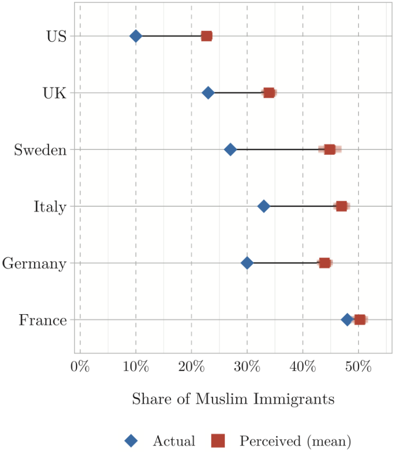
Content of the video experiment



There are drastic misperception on migrants



(a) Share of immigrants



(b) Share of Muslim immigrants

Note: Also documented misperception on education, attribute of poverty status

Salience reduces support, limited correction by information

	Imm Support Index (1)	Tax Top 1 (2)	Tax Bottom 50 (3)	Social Budget (4)	Inequality Serious Problem (5)	Donation Above Median (6)
Salience - Imm Questions First		-1.948***	0.914***	0.356	-0.0280**	-0.0479***
		(0.421)	(0.276)	(0.344)	(0.0132)	(0.0138)
Information - Share of Immigrants	0.0238**	-0.627	0.0449	-0.0885	-0.00590	-0.0165
	(0.0119)	(0.426)	(0.280)	(0.348)	(0.0134)	(0.0140)
Information - Origins of Immigrants	0.00573	-0.0662	0.0322	-0.175	0.00626	0.00208
	(0.0119)	(0.426)	(0.280)	(0.348)	(0.0134)	(0.0140)
Anecdote - Hard Work of Immigrants	0.0463***	0.0772	-0.212	0.851**	0.0158	0.00910
	(0.0119)	(0.426)	(0.279)	(0.347)	(0.0134)	(0.0139)
Share of Immigrants X Imm. Q. First		0.620	0.0622	-0.737	0.0134	0.0173
		(0.601)	(0.394)	(0.490)	(0.0188)	(0.0197)
Origins of Immigrants X Imm. Q. First		-0.00384	-0.237	-0.436	-0.0208	-0.0115
		(0.601)	(0.394)	(0.490)	(0.0189)	(0.0197)
Hard Work of Immigrants X Imm. Q. First		0.215	0.0813	-1.415***	-0.00817	0.00165
		(0.601)	(0.394)	(0.490)	(0.0188)	(0.0197)
Observations	19765	19765	19765	19731	19763	19765
Control mean	0.00	37.12	10.94	56.19	0.59	0.47

Driven by misperception on economic status of immigrants

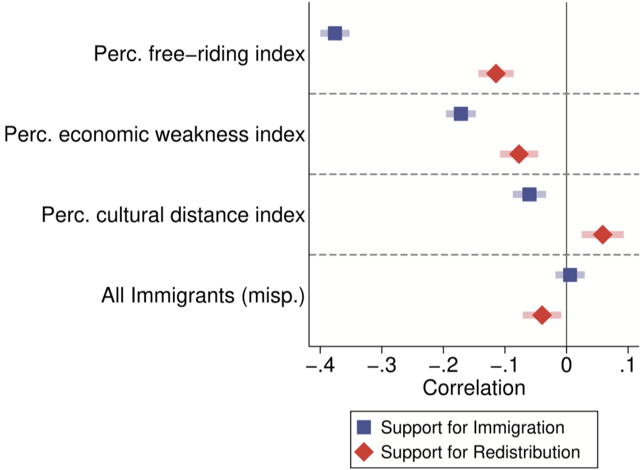


FIGURE 10

What drives support for immigration and redistribution?

Takeaways and discussions

Much of the debates are actually based on misperceptions on immigrants

- Overestimate size, cultural distance, and poverty status of migrants
- Just making people think about migration skews policy preferences
  - Driven by misperception on economic status of immigrants
  - Particularly dominant on older, less educated, poorer, and right-wing respondents
- Follow-up: Those with larger misperceptions less willing to pay for correct information

Remaining questions on policy preferences

- How to correct misperceptions that can skew policy preferences?
  - Otherwise, could be used by anti-immigration parties (or extremists)
  - Worrisome given that those who need this more are less willing

Hainmueller, Hiscox (2010): Attitudes toward Highly-Skilled and Low-Skilled Immigration: Evidence from a Survey Experiment [student presentation]

Takeaways and remaining questions

Migrants do contribute, but are often misunderstood

- Contribute in labor market, human capital, and politics
- Yet misperceptions about their efforts inhibit integration and further contribution
  - Natives often consider them as out-group and view them with prejudice
  - Often perpetuated by lack of credible information and misinformation from media
- Often leads to further social and political conflicts
  - Policy decisions are skewed against their favor
  - Often victimized by crime and conflict even in host societies

Remaining questions

- How do you improve two-way efforts to increase migrant-native integration?
  - Ways to address economic/cultural barriers and misinformation?
- Studies on political refugees and climate migrants
  - Limited possibility to return to homeland $\rightarrow$ Understanding integration is crucial